administration did not take suggestions that lifestyles would need to change in affluent nations, and the then US President, George Bush said, 'The American lifestyle is not negotiable'.[2] Two main reactions came to this –

i. *Developing* and *low-income nations* retaliated by removing references to the urgent need to slow population growth. These nations ultimately wanted to shift responsibility for environmental problems onto industrialised nations.

ii. The *Women's groups* from the USA and low-income nations supported these moves, arguing that population control 'jeopardises women's health, is disguised genocide, or places blame on women' rather than on the economic systems that exploit and misuse nature and people.[2]

The absence of a consensus on either of the two issues; ***population*** and ***consumption;*** and the political need for the concept of sustainable development to accommodate economic growth, means that the achievement towards sustainable development will depend on our ability to reduce the environmental impact of resource use through technological change. Many interest groups accept this political reality. They see continual growth in a ***finite world*** as possible, through the powers of technology, which will always be there to help us find new sources or provide alternatives if a particular resource appears to be running out. Otherwise, technology will help us to use and reuse what is left in the most efficient manner.

The legislative measures, economic instruments and consumer pressures are aimed at achieving technological changes such as recycling, waste minimisation, substitution of materials, changed production processes, pollution control and more efficient usage of resources. *The Commission for the Future*[3] says 'the challenge of sustainable development is to find new products, processes, and technologies which are environmentally friendly while they deliver the things we want'. This view is generally held across the spectrum of political views as per which: an ecologically sustainable society 'will require large amounts of new technology, technological innovation, modern management practices' as well as changes to lifestyle.[4] Same group of experts believe that environmental damage can be reversed